

James McLaren

Agentic QA | Quality Engineering | Test Automation

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PROFILE

Quality engineering leader with 13+ years' experience building QA functions and driving delivery across complex technical environments. Now working in an AI-first capacity as the sole automation engineer at io.finnnet, sustaining and extending the full automation estate through agentic workflows built on Claude Code, covering nightly triage, root cause analysis, test generation and reporting, and fixing product defects directly in the codebase rather than handing them off. Converted a four-person QA function into an agent-driven operation run single-handedly, without loss of coverage. Previously built the io.finnnet QA function from zero to four engineers, establishing a Playwright/TypeScript framework that reached 80%+ automated regression coverage across MPC technology, smart contracts, 20+ blockchain networks, exchange integrations and banking partnerships. Before that, led 11 QA Engineers across 5 SCRUM teams at YouView. Known internally as the person who unblocks problems, understands how products actually work, and always knows the real state of play across deployments and environments.

Seeking remote Agentic QA, QA Engineering or Quality Engineering roles.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

io.finnnet | Remote | December 2021 - Present

Digital asset custody, MPC and tokenisation platform

Lead Software Quality Assurance Engineer | January 2026 - Present

- Sole engineer responsible for all test automation across a multi-product blockchain platform, sustaining coverage previously maintained by a team of four by rebuilding the function around agentic workflows.
- Built an agentic QA capability on Claude Code, developing reusable Skills that automatically triage nightly test runs, clustering failures, identifying likely root cause and proposing fixes, then raising Jira tickets directly from triaged results, so each day starts with a prioritised list rather than raw logs.
- Fix product defects directly in the application codebase rather than raising and handing off, closing the loop from failing test to shipped fix and removing a dependency on developer capacity for QA-found issues.
- Embedded AI agents into test generation, root cause analysis and reporting, replacing manual triage of raw nightly logs with an automated prioritised failure list and substantially expanding automated coverage in a short period.
- Author reusable Claude Skills and prompt templates across work repositories and personal projects, standardising QA workflows across the business and reducing token spend on repeatable tasks.
- Claude Code as the primary agentic tool, with AWS Kiro, OpenAI Codex and CodeRabbit used for code review and proof-of-concept work, keeping pace with a fast-moving tooling landscape.
- Generated QASE test cases via AI for compliance, network transfer and vault operation flows, converting requirements into structured coverage in a fraction of the manual time.
- Built an Appium/WebDriver mobile automation framework to extend coverage to native app releases.
- Continuously refactored the Playwright/TypeScript framework and its Page Object Model architecture, improving stability and maintainability while adding coverage across new product areas and dedicated client environments.
- Set up Allure reporting across the automation suite, giving engineers and stakeholders visibility into pass/fail trends, flaky tests and historical results in place of manual status updates.
- Optimised nightly CI jobs and reporting pipelines so results are triaged and ready before the working day starts.
- Delivered QA for the multi-million dollar Tokenization launch and the onboarding of top 20 crypto exchanges, OTC desks and banking clients, acting as technical point of contact for integrations.

Head of QA | December 2021 - January 2026

- Built the QA function from scratch, hiring, managing and mentoring a team of 4 engineers across a complex multi-product blockchain environment.
- Developed a Playwright/TypeScript automation framework comprising hundreds of end-to-end tests, automating 80%+ of the regression pack and significantly accelerating release cycles.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines via GitHub Actions with automated test runs on deployment, production smoke tests and rollback triggers on failure.
- Led testing across 20+ blockchain networks including Ethereum, Bitcoin, Solana, Tron and Ripple, and tested MPC (multi-party computation) technology across mobile devices and server-hosted virtual devices, identifying complex edge cases in cryptographic signing flows.
- Delivered QA for smart contract functionality including minting, burning and transaction logic on private EVM networks built for banking clients, and tested integrations with Bitfinex, Kiln and WalletConnect.

- Introduced AI into the QA process for test authoring and root cause analysis, laying the groundwork for the fully agentic workflow that followed.
- Acted as the coordination point between tech leads across multiple workstreams and as release manager for 15+ major releases, aligning QA priorities, identifying cross-team dependencies and unblocking deployment issues.
- Served as the go-to person for product state, deployment status and production readiness, regularly pushing back on releases that were not ready.

YouView TV Ltd | London | July 2014 - December 2021

QA Manager

- Led a team of 11 QA Engineers as direct reports, distributed across 5 SCRUM teams covering manual and automated testing for set-top box software serving 2 million+ customers.
- Managed a team of 3 SDETs who built Selenium-based automation running directly on physical set-top box hardware, as well as component test suites for the React/HTML5 UI layer.
- Delivered QA for major product launches including the HTML5 UI migration replacing legacy ActionScript, the Sony Android TV app, and the 4K set-top box in partnership with BT, where I was the technical lead.
- Led testing for the first UK Netflix integration in the connected TV space.
- Oversaw testing across the full stack: middleware on Humax, Huawei and Sony hardware, the frontend software layer, and streaming via digital and DTT.
- Drove full automation of the deployment pipeline, eliminating manual regression and accelerating release confidence.
- Handled performance management directly, addressing underperformance and developing team capability, and navigated team restructures while maintaining delivery and morale.
- Played a key role in establishing the graduate scheme and contributed to the internship programme, with several graduates progressing to permanent roles.

Accenture | London | August 2011 - July 2014

Graduate Software Engineer

- Worked across several large-scale client projects including DWP and BT Sport.

SKILLS

- AI and Agentic: Claude Code, Claude Skills, Agentic QA Workflows, AI-Assisted Test Generation, AI Root Cause Analysis, Prompt Engineering, AWS Kiro, OpenAI Codex, CodeRabbit
- Automation and Testing: Playwright, TypeScript, JavaScript, Appium, WebDriver, Selenium, API Testing, Test Strategy, Regression Automation, QASE, Allure
- Engineering and Infrastructure: Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Docker, Docker Compose, AWS, Node.js
- Domain: Blockchain, Web3, MPC, Smart Contracts, EVM, Digital Asset Custody, Exchange and Banking Integrations
- Leadership: Team Building, Hiring and Recruitment, Mentoring, Release Management, Stakeholder Management, Agile (SCRUM and Kanban)

PROJECTS

west.investments - Portfolio Management Platform for Alternative Assets

February 2026 - Present | TypeScript, Vercel, Supabase, Stripe, Poketrace API, Claude Code

- Designed and built a portfolio management tool for tracking alternative assets, with a niche in Pokemon card investments, enabling users to monitor collection value and performance alongside managed portfolios for investors.
- Built entirely through agentic development with Claude Code, from schema design and Stripe billing through to authentication and deployment.

prempod.com - Football Content Creator Directory

January 2026 | TypeScript, Vercel, Supabase, Resend, Claude Code

- Community-driven site helping football supporters find content creators covering their specific club, built end to end using agentic development with Claude Code.

EDUCATION

BSc Applied Computing, First Class

University of Dundee | 2007 - 2011